

1.1 Landscapes of the UK

The UK has a very distinct natural landscape which has been shaped over millions of years by a core set of geomorphic processes. This theme gives learners an understanding of the physical geography of the UK, its key landscapes and the geomorphic processes which

have driven the changes to UK landscapes. Case studies will be used to contextualise how climate, geology and human activity work in combination with geomorphic processes to shape two landscapes in the UK.

Section	Key Ideas	Content	Scale
1.1.1	The physical landscapes of the UK have distinctive characteristics.	• Overview of the distribution of areas of upland, lowland and glaciated landscapes. • Overview of the distinctive characteristics of these landscapes including their geology, climate and human activity.	N
1.1.2	There are a number of geomorphic processes which create distinctive landscapes.	• The definitions of the main geomorphic processes including types of weathering (mechanical, chemical, biological), mass movement (sliding, slumping), erosion (abrasion, hydraulic action, attrition, solution), transport (traction, saltation, suspension, solution) and deposition.	
1.1.3	Rivers create a range of landforms which change with distance from their source within a river basin.	• The formation of river landforms (waterfall, gorge, V-shaped valley, floodplain, levee, meander, ox-bow lake).	R, L, F
1.1.4	There are a range of landforms within the coastal landscape.	• The formation of coastal landforms (headland, bay, cave, arch, stack, beach, spit).	R, L, F
1.1.5	Landscapes are dynamic and differ depending on their geology, climate and human activity.	• Two case studies, one UK river basin and one UK coastal landscape, to cover: ◦ the geomorphic processes operating at different scales and how they are influenced by geology and climate ◦ landforms and features associated with your case study ◦ how human activity, including management, works in combination with geomorphic processes to impact the landscape.	R, L, F